



Digsby

Digsby is a free all-in-one instant messenger with social networking services support



Peeko chat

Peeko Chat is a chat addon for Firefox that lets you chat with others members on a particular site

Talking with the world!

There isn't any better way to communicate than to just talk and that's something that almost every instant messaging services allows you to do. Group voice conversations aren't always present in these applications, though. Some services which supported group voice chats shut down the feature after misuse of the service.

Programs such as Ventrilo and Teamspeak are developed specifically for voice chat. They are used a lot amongst gamers, but they make excellent sense if you want to have a large group conversation.

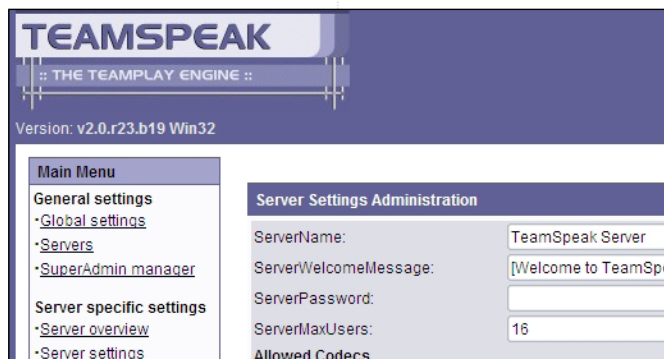
Of the two, Teamspeak allows more advanced features and detailed customization of the service. The software is

Software resources

mIRC
(www.mirc.com)
HydraIRC
(www.hydrairc.com)
XChat
(www.xchat.org, www.silverex.org)
Hybrid IRC
(www.ircd-hybrid.org)
Inspire IRCd
(www.inspircd.org)
BewareIRCd
(<http://ircd.bircd.org>)
UnrealIRCd
(www.unrealircd.com)
OpenFire
(www.igniterealtime.org/projects/openfire/)
Mibbit
(www.mibbit.com)
XAMPP
(www.xampp.com)
Teamspeak
(www.goteteamspeak.com)
Ventrilo
(www.ventrilo.com)

completely free to use and there are no limitations whatsoever. It's even possible to experience considerably better quality than with a telephone line. Download and install the server and client for Teamspeak from the site – www.goteteamspeak.com. Those connecting to your server will only need to install the client.

Teamspeak's server allows a lot of control over the bandwidth and permissions given to every user. Settings can be put in place to keep bandwidth requirements to a minimum. The minimum



Modifying TeamSpeak server information details

bandwidth that Teamspeak needs to host a server for a single user is somewhere around 2 kB/s. Most connections today have at least 15 to 20 kB/s upload speeds, and this can easily handle a server for some seven to ten users.

The installation wizard will display a user name and password for the administrator and super administrator. Note these for future reference as they will be required to control the server. Once the software is installed, run the server application. Right-click on the system tray icon and click on Administration. Use the superadmin account and login to the account.

Setting up Teamspeak

First, select the server that you want to configure. Do this by clicking on Servers and then on Select. Teamspeak lets you run multiple voice chat servers on a single server application. Click on add server to do this. Once you select your server, you can view and change all the server settings by clicking



The connection window lets you store details of multiple servers

on the Server settings link on the left.

Here, you can change the server name and most importantly, enable or disable codecs. The SuperAdmin manager and User manager link allows you to add and manage users. The permissions can be changed from the Server permissions sub-section in

the same menu on the left. The user manager allows registered users to be created. By default, Teamspeak allows anonymous users to connect. Just like the hierarchy of IRC server administrators, there are channel admins and operators in Teamspeak. Each of them has limited rights allotted.

The permission names are self-explanatory, and disabling or enabling them can be done by simply selecting or deselecting the checkbox. Just click Save at the end when all the changes have been made.

Connecting and talking with people

You can connect to a Teamspeak server using an anonymous account or using a registered account. Either way, you have to click on Connection > Quick Connect. Enter the

server address of the server, a nickname and the authentication information if you have any. Click on Connect and you should connect to the server.

If you click on Connection > Connect, you get the option of saving the server information for future use. You can directly come to this menu and double click on the server of your choice to connect. This window will also allow you to list all the servers available on the internet.

If you are a channel operator or a superadmin, you get the rights to create a channel and change its settings. You can even move users from one channel to another by dragging and dropping nicknames between channels. This is great when you have more than one group, and you do not want members of one group hearing the discussions of other groups.

Come chat with us on the Digit IRC server!

We now have our own IRC server and a channel for all you guys to mingle on.
Server address: irc.thinkdigit.com

Port: 6667

Channel name: #Digit

The whole concept of connecting to chat servers, be it voice or text-based, isn't only for communicating. It's become a way of life for many. There's fierce discussions on IRC and there are many online communities thriving on it. It's one of the most interactive ways to learn new things.

Staying idle on IRC channels is a way of constantly keeping track of what goes on on the server. People don't necessarily have to be chatting all day.

It just happens that in a crowded room, you have some people talking about something or the other all the time. This kind of conversation and bonding has been present on the internet and people have been doing this for almost two decades now. Hope to see you all on the Digit server soon... 